



Your baby will have gained weight steadily during these final weeks, with fat being laid down under the skin. If born now, they would have a plump, rounded appearance.

ASK A MIDWIFE

I don't often swear but is it true that I'm likely to subject my partner to verbal abuse during labor? Possibly, but no one will blame you if you do! Giving birth can be incredibly painful, and you may feel emotional, irritable, shaky, and even nauseated. Don't worry too much about what you say and do: try to stay focused on the birth and ask for pain relief if you need it. Most birth partners will be forgiving and are unlikely to take the abuse personally. They will realize that you might not quite be yourself during childbirth—and if they've been by your side throughout labor will be fully understanding of what you're going through. You may also be irritable with your caregivers, but they will be used to this!

THE DUE DATE